
What to Expect for Your Pet's MRI

Before the MRI

- You will sign consent forms and leave a deposit.
- Your pet will need **blood work** to make sure anesthesia is safe.
- Older pets need **chest X-rays** to screen for cancer before anesthesia.
- A **cardiology consultation or echocardiogram** may be needed if there are heart concerns.
- Follow our fasting instructions (usually no food after midnight; water is fine unless told otherwise).
- Leave a phone number where you can be reached **during the procedure**.

During the MRI

- Your pet is under **general anesthesia** and closely monitored throughout.
- They receive **IV fluids** during the scan.
- A board-certified **neurologist reviews the images in real time**.
- The scan may take **several hours**, including anesthesia preparation and recovery.
- Additional tests, such as a **spinal tap**, may be recommended and done during the same anesthesia — we will call you first.

After the MRI

- Staff will schedule a time for you to return and **discuss results** with the neurologist.
- The MRI is also reviewed by a **board-certified radiologist**.
- Your pet may be sleepy or wobbly for up to 24 hours — see our *After General Anesthesia* handout.

Please note: pick-up and discussion times are estimates and may change with the day's emergencies and schedule. We will call you if there is a delay.